

Needs Analysis Quick Guide

A meeting-ready structure for turning a visible business concern into a clear decision about what should happen next.

Use this guide to: separate the stated request from the underlying need, collect evidence, rank the options, define ownership, and leave the meeting with a decision receipt.

What this is

A reusable working guide for discovery meetings, internal reviews, and service scoping.

What this is not

A diagnosis made without evidence, a software recommendation, or permission to begin implementation.

Start with the result, not the tool.

Capture the request in the customer's words. Then rewrite it as an observable result the business can recognize.

What was requested?

What result would make this useful?

Who experiences the issue?

Who owns the decision?

Evidence already available

- ☐ Customer reviews and repeated language
- ☐ Website, forms, profiles, and inquiry path
- ☐ Existing reports, turnaround times, or backlog
- ☐ Staff observations and process documents
- ☐ Examples of the expected output

Follow the work from signal to outcome.

1 Trigger

What starts the process?

2 Action

What happens now, and in which system?

3 Handoff

Where does ownership change or information stall?

4 Outcome

What is recorded, delivered, or left unresolved?

Choose the smallest useful next move.

Option	Expected value	Effort	Risk	Evidence needed

Recommended next move

Explicitly out of scope

End with ownership and a measurable result.

Decision	
Owner	
First due date	
Acceptance evidence	
KPI	
OKR	
Next review	

Close the loop: confirm what was decided, what was deferred, who approves the next action, and what proof will count as complete.

